

■ SLO-3 Department-Level Intervention: Audience Adaptation

SLO-3: *An ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences.*

This rubric captures the department-level intervention for **Audience Adaptation (Apply → Evaluate)** in **mid-program, communication-intensive courses**.

Student Struggles (Summary)

Students perform strongly overall in communication, with **Apply** and **Create** consistently high. However, **Evaluate** is slightly weaker: students often do not critically adapt messaging for diverse audiences (technical peer, managerial, general public) or fully integrate professional and technical perspectives. The dip to **72% in Sp24** shows performance can falter under higher expectations for professionalism and audience awareness.

Overlay Rubric: Quick Steps (SLO-3 — Audience Adaptation)

- **Grade as usual.** Continue using your existing lab reports, project reports, and presentations.
- **Add an audience-adaptation piece:** require students to present the same work for two distinct audiences:
 - *Lab courses:* add **one paragraph** at the end of the lab report for a **managerial/non-technical** audience, alongside the technical discussion.
 - *Project courses:* add **one slide** (or a short **summary section**) tailored for **managers/sponsors**, in addition to the technical version.
- **When grading these summaries:** verify (a) technical clarity/correctness, (b) tone/terminology/structure appropriate to each audience, (c) integration of technical (focus on the engineering details) + professional (focus on the implications and context of the technical work — cost, risk, schedule, safety, ethics, sustainability, impact on stakeholders) perspectives.
- **Your task:** keep grading normally — just ensure the assignment includes **one technical** and **one managerial** audience component.

Performance Indicator (PI)	Level	Mid-Program Expectation	Bloom's Link
PI-4: Audience Adaptation	Novice	Single-audience communication; tone/terminology not adjusted; professional context missing or superficial; errors/omissions impede understanding.	Apply
	Apprentice	Attempts limited tailoring for a second audience but with inconsistent tone/terminology; minimal integration of professional perspective; messaging only partially effective.	Apply
	Practitioner	Provides targeted versions for ≥2 audiences (e.g., technical report + managerial summary or technical deck + sponsor slide); tone, structure, and visuals are appropriate; professional and technical perspectives are coherently integrated; messaging is effective.	Apply → Evaluate
	Expert	Highly polished, audience-optimized deliverables for ≥2 audiences; precise tone and vocabulary; strong narrative coherence; explicit trade-offs/implications (e.g., higher cost vs. improved safety, states directly what is being gained, what is being lost, and why it matters) communicated clearly; delivery is professional and persuasive.	Evaluate